WKL Labs

WORDPRESS HEALTH CHECK

Harbor & Pine Law

Speed, Core Web Vitals, security, SEO, accessibility and maintenance: what we found on the current site, what it costs the firm, and a fixed-price plan to fix it.

SITE REVIEWED
harborpinelaw.example.com
7 public pages, WordPress 7.1.4, Elementor 4.3.5

REPORT DATE
October 30, 2026

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PREPARED FOR
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Confidential, for the firm's use

IN ONE PAGE

The site is sound where it counts, and slow where it shows.

Content, accessibility and on-page SEO are in good shape: every page scores 100 on those checks. The problem is delivery. The two pages with photos take 3.6 to 4.8 seconds to show their main content on a phone, well past the 2.5 second line Google uses for ranking signals. The cause is a standard first-pass setup: 18 font weights loaded from Google, icon fonts, 240 to 460 KB photos, and 30 to 38 requests per page where 5 would do. Security basics also need attention: a guessable admin login with a weak password, software versions advertised in the page source, and no backups.



Speed
Lighthouse, worst page (81 to 97)



Core Web Vitals
LCP fails on 2 of 7 pages



Security
passed; 4 fail, 1 partial, 2 not checked



SEO
Lighthouse, all 7 pages



Accessibility
Lighthouse, all 7 pages



Maintenance
checks passed

Top five fixes, ranked by impact against effort

#	FIX	BUSINESS IMPACT	EFFORT	EXPECTED RESULT
1	Resize and convert the two full-width photos (WebP, responsive sizes, lazy below the fold)	Brings the two slowest pages under the 2.5 s line; these are the practice-area pages that ads and search send people to	S	LCP 4.8 s to about 2.1 s
2	Self-host one font file instead of 18 weights from Google Fonts; render icons as inline SVG	Removes the third-party request every visitor waits on before text appears	S	FCP 2.0 to 2.3 s down to 0.8 to 1.4 s
3	Rename the admin account, set a strong password, add login rate limiting and two-factor sign-in	Closes the most common way small-firm sites get taken over	S	Login brute force blocked
4	Set up automatic off-site backups with a tested restore	A hacked or broken site becomes a 20-minute restore instead of a rebuild	S	Daily backups, 30-day retention
5	Remove unused theme, block, form and builder assets; inline the small stylesheets; enable page caching	Cuts 30 to 38 requests per page down to 4 to 6 and keeps the site fast as content grows	M	Perf 81 to 97 up to 99 to 100

HOW WE MEASURED

Lighthouse 12.8, mobile preset (simulated slow 4G, 4x CPU slowdown), run on October 30, 2026 against all seven public pages. Core Web Vitals thresholds: Largest Contentful Paint (LCP) 2.5 s, Cumulative Layout Shift (CLS) 0.1, Total Blocking Time (TBT) 200 ms. Full Lighthouse reports are attached as an appendix.

01 Full-size photos on the practice-area pages FAIL

SPEED LCP EFFORT S

FOUND

Two photos were uploaded as 1920 px JPEGs and served at full size: pines.jpg at 457 KB, plus ridge.jpg on the Personal injury page. No responsive sizes, no modern format, no lazy loading.

WHY IT MATTERS

These are the Family law and Personal injury pages, the ones a search ad or a referral link lands on. On a phone the page's main image appears at 4.8 s and 3.6 s. Google's "good" line is 2.5 s, and visitors on mobile data start leaving well before that.

EVIDENCE

```
Family law     LCP 4.8 s   page weight 700 KB   Lighthouse: responsive-
images savings 405 KB, modern-formats savings 188 KB
Personal injury LCP 3.6 s   page weight 479 KB   Lighthouse: responsive-
images savings 212 KB, modern-formats savings 121 KB
```

FIX

Re-encode as WebP at 1200 px with generated sizes (srcset) and quality 60, set width and height, lazy-load below the fold. The 457 KB photo becomes about 82 KB with no visible loss.

02 Eighteen font weights from Google, plus three icon-font stylesheets FAIL

SPEED FCP EFFORT S

FOUND

The page builder requests the Newsreader family in every weight and italic (100 to 900) from fonts.googleapis.com, and loads Font Awesome's three stylesheets for the handful of icons in the trust strip.

WHY IT MATTERS

Every visitor's browser connects to a third-party server and waits for its stylesheet before drawing any text. First text appears at 2.0 to 2.3 s on every page. The firm's headline and phone number should be visible in under a second.

EVIDENCE

```
fonts.googleapis.com/css?
family=Newsreader:100,100italic,200,...,900,900italic   (1 external CSS
request + font files)
Render-blocking resources per page: 16 to 28  (Lighthouse "render-blocking-
resources")
```

FIX

Turn off the builder's Google Fonts option, self-host Newsreader as one variable woff2 (400 to 500) plus one italic file with font-display: swap and a preload. Switch the builder to inline SVG icons so the icon-font CSS never loads.

03 Scripts and stylesheets loading on pages that do not use them NEEDS WORK

SPEED REQUESTS EFFORT M

FOUND

jQuery, jQuery Migrate, the builder's frontend runtime and widget chunks, the form plugin's submission script, the emoji script and the block-library stylesheet load on all seven pages. None of the pages use sliders, tabs or popups, so most of it does nothing.

WHY IT MATTERS

30 to 38 requests per page on a site that needs 4 to 6. Each one is a round trip on a phone connection, and the home page shifts layout (CLS 0.031) while late stylesheets arrive. It also means every plugin update is a chance for something unneeded to break the page.

EVIDENCE

```
Home: 38 requests, 325 KB, 28 render-blocking, CLS 0.031   Contact: 33 requests, 241 KB, CLS 0.037
Scripts on every page: jquery.min.js, jquery-migrate.min.js, webpack.runtime.min.js, frontend-modules.min.js, frontend.min.js, form-submission.js, wp-emoji-release.min.js
```

FIX

Remove the parent theme CSS, block-library CSS, icon font, default form styles, jQuery, builder frontend JS and the emoji script on pages that do not need them; set the builder's CSS print method to internal and inline the remaining small stylesheets; add page caching with long cache headers on uploads. Scoped so that adding an interactive widget later re-enables the builder script on that page only.

Core Web Vitals by page, current site (mobile)

PAGE	PERFORMANCE	LCP	FCP	CLS	REQUESTS	WEIGHT	STATUS
Home	96	2.3 s	2.3 s	0.031	38	325 KB	PASSES
Personal injury	88	3.6 s	2.0 s	0.001	35	479 KB	LCP FAILS
Family law	81	4.8 s	2.0 s	0.001	35	700 KB	LCP FAILS
Our attorneys	97	2.1 s	2.0 s	0.002	30	210 KB	PASSES
Results	97	2.2 s	2.0 s	0.001	30	209 KB	PASSES
Contact	97	2.3 s	2.0 s	0.037	33	241 KB	PASSES
Legal	97	2.1 s	2.0 s	0.001	30	209 KB	PASSES

Total Blocking Time is 0 ms on every page: the site is not slow because of heavy scripts running, it is slow because of what it downloads before it can draw. That is the easier problem to have.

EIGHT CHECKS

Security: one check passed, four failed, and all four are cheap to fix.

Checked from the outside and the WordPress dashboard; anything needing server access is marked "not checked" rather than guessed.

CHECK	RESULT	WHAT WE SAW	FIX
Administrator account name and password	FAIL	The only administrator is "admin" with a weak password; "admin" is the first name every automated attack tries.	Create a new administrator with a non-obvious name and a long passphrase, demote and remove "admin".
Login protection (rate limiting, two-factor)	FAIL	No limit on failed sign-in attempts and no second factor.	One lightweight login-protection plugin; two-factor for both partners and the assistant.
Software version exposure	FAIL	Page source advertises "WordPress 7.1.4" and "Elementor 4.3.5" and appends version numbers to asset URLs.	Remove the generator tags and version query strings (a few lines in the child theme).
Backups	FAIL	No backup plugin or host backup is configured. A bad update or a compromise means a rebuild.	Daily automatic backup to off-site storage, 30-day retention, one restore tested and documented.
Plugins installed and current	PASS	Three plugins (Elementor, Fluent Forms, Yoast SEO), all current, none abandoned or duplicated.	Keep as is; add a monthly update routine (see Maintenance).
Contact form protection	NEEDS WORK	Submit requests carry a one-time token (confirmed). The plugin's honeypot and submission limit are available but off, so bots can flood the intake form.	Turn on the honeypot and a per-address submission limit (dashboard settings, no code).
XML-RPC and REST user enumeration	NOT CHECKED	Both are on by default in WordPress; the live server's setting could not be confirmed from the copy reviewed.	Disable XML-RPC unless the firm uses the mobile app; block the users endpoint for anonymous requests.
HTTPS, security headers, file editing in dashboard	NOT CHECKED	Needs the live host; checked in the first hour of any fix engagement.	Force HTTPS, add standard headers, set DISALLOW_FILE_EDIT.

Why this matters to a law firm specifically

The intake form carries names, phone numbers and a short description of a legal matter. A compromised site can collect those submissions quietly or redirect visitors to a lookalike, with no visible defacement. The four failing checks are the usual path to that outcome; each takes under two hours to close.

SEO

Technical SEO is in order 100 / 100

- Every page has a unique title and meta description, one H1, a canonical URL and Open Graph tags (Yoast SEO).
- LegalService and Attorney structured data validate; FAQ markup present on both practice-area pages.
- sitemap.xml and robots.txt are present and consistent.
- The one open item is speed itself: page experience signals feed ranking, and two pages currently fail LCP.

ACCESSIBILITY

Automated checks pass 100 / 100

- Colour contrast, labels, landmarks, heading order and focus states pass on all seven pages.
- Form fields are 48 px tall with visible labels and a single focus ring; all controls meet the 44 px target size.
- Not covered by automation: keyboard walk-through of the mobile menu and the FAQ accordions, and screen-reader reading order. Recommended as a one-hour manual pass after the speed fixes.

MAINTENANCE

Six checks, two passed

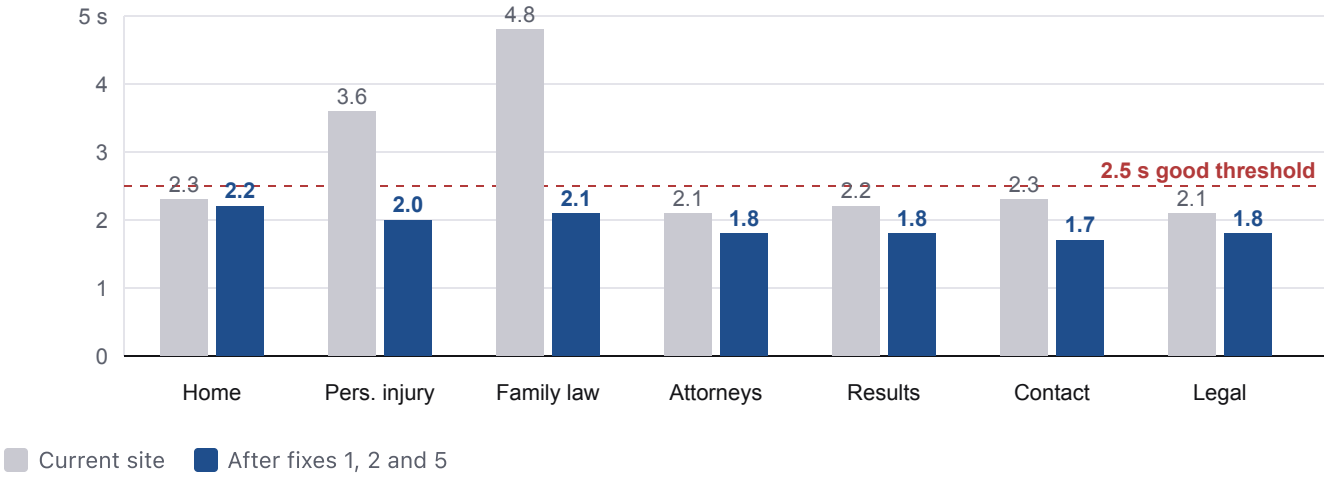
CHECK	RESULT	NOTE
WordPress core current	PASS	7.1.4, the current release at review time.
Theme and plugins current	PASS	Hello Elementor child theme, Elementor 4.3.5, Fluent Forms 6.2.16, Yoast SEO 28.8.
Update routine with a staging copy	FAIL	Updates are applied (or not) by hand on the live site. No staging copy exists to test an update before visitors see it.
Backups and tested restore	FAIL	See Security. Counted here as well because it is the maintenance safety net.
Uptime and error monitoring	FAIL	Nothing alerts the firm if the site goes down or the intake form stops sending.
Documented owner access	FAIL	Hosting, domain and admin logins are known to one person. A short access sheet in the firm's password manager removes that single point of failure.

WHAT THE FIXES DELIVER

Measured on an optimized copy of the same site.

To avoid promising numbers we cannot back, we applied fixes 1, 2 and 5 to an exact copy of the current site (same pages, same copy, same form, same builder) and re-ran Lighthouse under identical settings. These are the measured results, not projections.

Largest Contentful Paint by page, mobile (seconds, lower is better)



METRIC (MOBILE)	HOME, NOW	HOME, AFTER	FAMILY LAW, NOW	FAMILY LAW, AFTER
Lighthouse Performance	96	**99**	81	**99**
Largest Contentful Paint	2.3 s	**2.2 s**	4.8 s	**2.1 s**
First Contentful Paint	2.3 s	**1.4 s**	2.0 s	**0.9 s**
Cumulative Layout Shift	0.031	**0**	0.001	**0**
Page weight	325 KB	**223 KB**	700 KB	**185 KB**
Requests	38	**6**	35	**5**
Render-blocking resources	28	**0**	16	**0**

Across all seven pages: Performance 81 to 97 now, 99 to 100 after. Accessibility, Best Practices and SEO stay at 100. Figures are from the attached Lighthouse reports; numbers on the live host will vary slightly with the server and the visitor's connection.

FIXED PRICE, NO HOURLY SURPRISES

Three ways to take this on.

Every tier is done on a staging copy first, measured with the same Lighthouse settings as this report, and handed over with before and after numbers.

TIER 1

Speed fix

$350

Fixes 1, 2 and 5. About 3 working days.

- Photos re-encoded, responsive, lazy
- One self-hosted font, inline SVG icons
- Unused assets removed per page
- Inlined CSS, page caching, cache headers
- Re-measured: all pages Performance 99+, LCP under 2.5 s

TIER 2, RECOMMENDED

Speed and security

$650

Tier 1 plus fixes 3 and 4 and the other four security items. About 5 working days.

- Everything in Tier 1
- New admin account, "admin" removed, two-factor for 3 users
- Login rate limiting
- Version exposure removed; XML-RPC and user endpoint closed
- HTTPS forced, security headers, file editing disabled
- Daily off-site backups with one tested restore

TIER 3

Full tune-up

$950

Tier 2 plus the maintenance gaps and a manual accessibility pass. About 8 working days.

- Everything in Tier 2
- Staging copy and a written update routine
- Uptime and form-delivery monitoring
- Access sheet for the firm's password manager
- One-hour keyboard and screen-reader pass with fixes
- First 30 days of the care plan included

Order of work (Tier 2 shown)

DAY	WORK	YOU SEE
1	Staging copy, backups configured, server-side checks completed, baseline measured	Access sheet draft, baseline numbers
2	Images, fonts, icons	Staging link, LCP under 2.5 s on every page
3	Asset removal, CSS inlining, caching	Staging link, requests down to 4 to 6
4	Admin account, two-factor, login limits, version exposure, headers	Short walkthrough for both partners (15 minutes)
5	Go live, re-measure on the real host, tested restore	This report's page 7 re-done with live numbers

KEEP IT FIXED

A care plan so this report does not need to be written twice.

Most of the findings here are not mistakes, they are what happens to any site nobody is responsible for. The plan below makes one person responsible, with a monthly note so the firm knows what was done.

CARE PLAN

WordPress Care

$75 per month, cancel any time

- Core, theme and plugin updates applied on staging first, then live, every month
- Daily off-site backups kept 30 days; quarterly restore test
- Uptime check every 5 minutes; intake-form delivery test weekly
- Monthly Lighthouse run on all pages; anything under 90 gets fixed inside the plan
- Security scan and log review monthly
- Up to one hour of small content edits per month
- A one-page monthly note: what was updated, what was measured, what to watch

What is not included

- New pages, redesigns and new features (quoted separately at a fixed price)
- Hosting and domain fees (paid by the firm directly, so the firm always owns them)
- Recovery from a compromise that happened before the plan started

How to say yes

1. Reply with the tier you want (Tier 2 is the recommendation).
2. Share hosting and WordPress admin access through your password manager, not by email.
3. Work starts within two business days; you get a staging link on day 2.

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Method and scope

Reviewed on October 30, 2026: the seven public pages of harborpinelaw.example.com, their page source and loaded assets, and the WordPress dashboard (users, plugins, theme, settings). Speed figures come from Lighthouse 12.8 in its mobile preset; the "after" figures come from an optimized copy of the same site measured under the same settings. Security and maintenance checks were performed from the outside and the dashboard; items needing server access are marked "not checked". No changes were made to the live site during this review. Appendix: 14 Lighthouse HTML reports (7 current, 7 optimized copy).